

Synthetic Knowledge Base Articles — Incident Deflection Prototype

Purpose: Synthetic KB content for testing ServiceNow Virtual Agent Knowledge Search deflection logic. Not real L&G documentation — written for this prototype only, per the project's GDPR/data-handling approach (no live employee or company data used in testing).

Scope: P3 (Moderate) / P4 (Low) priority incidents only — low-complexity, high-volume issue types suitable for self-service resolution. P1/P2 incidents are explicitly out of scope for deflection and should always route straight to a ticket.

Template fields used (matches standard ServiceNow KB structure):

Symptoms — what the user actually sees/reports (this is closest to real user phrasing, useful for NLU training)

Cause — brief root cause, gives the article more matchable text and makes it feel like genuine documentation, not just a script

Resolution — numbered steps

Escalation trigger — the explicit condition your VA topic should detect to stop self-service and raise an incident

Related Articles — cross-references, useful if you want to test/demonstrate "related content" suggestions later

Category 1: Password / Account Resets

KB0010001 — Reset your L&G network password

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Password/Account | **Keywords:** password reset, forgot password, locked out, change password, expired password, can't log in

Symptoms: User reports being unable to log in to their L&G device or account; login screen shows "password expired" or "incorrect password" despite entering what they believe is correct.

Cause: Network passwords expire automatically every 90 days as a security policy. This is the most common cause of login failure and is frequently mistaken by users for account compromise or a system fault.

Resolution:

From any L&G device, go to the self-service password portal (accessible from the Windows login screen via "Reset password").

Enter your employee ID and verify your identity via the MFA method registered on your account.

Set a new password meeting the minimum complexity requirement (12+ characters, one number, one symbol).

Wait 2-3 minutes for the change to sync across systems before attempting to log in again.

Escalation trigger: User does not have MFA configured and cannot verify identity through the self-service portal.

Related Articles: KB0010002 (Account locked), KB0060001 (MFA not receiving code)

KB0010002 — Account locked after failed login attempts

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Password/Account | **Keywords:** account locked, too many attempts, can't log in, locked account, security lockout

Symptoms: User sees an explicit "account locked" message, or repeated login attempts silently fail with no clear error.

Cause: Accounts lock automatically after 5 failed login attempts within a 15-minute window, as a brute-force protection control. This is a deliberate security feature, not a fault.

Resolution:

Confirm you're using your current password (check email for any recent "your password was changed" notification, which suggests you're using an outdated one).

Wait for the 30-minute auto-unlock rather than repeatedly retrying — further attempts extend the lock period.

If the account remains locked after 30 minutes, or you suspect unauthorised access attempts (e.g. lockout without you having attempted to log in), do not continue retrying.

Escalation trigger: Lock persists beyond 30 minutes, or the user suspects the lockout was not caused by their own failed attempts (possible unauthorised access).

Related Articles: KB0010001 (Password reset)

Category 2: VPN Connectivity

KB0020001 — VPN client won't connect

Priority: P3 | **Category:** VPN | **Keywords:** VPN not connecting, VPN failed, can't connect VPN, VPN timeout, remote access, VPN authentication failed

Symptoms: VPN client shows a connection failure, timeout, or authentication error when attempting to connect from off-site.

Cause: In the large majority of cases this is caused by an expired network password, since VPN authentication uses the same credentials as device login but doesn't always surface a clear "password expired" message — it often just shows a generic failure instead.

Resolution:

Confirm you have an active internet connection independent of the VPN (try loading any website first). Fully close the VPN client, including checking it isn't still running in the system tray, then reopen it.

Confirm your network password hasn't expired via KB0010001 — this resolves the majority of VPN connection failures.

Restart your device if the client still won't authenticate after a fresh password check.

Escalation trigger: VPN still fails after a confirmed valid, non-expired password and a device restart — this typically indicates a certificate or client installation fault.

Related Articles: KB0010001 (Password reset), KB0020002 (VPN connects but no access)

KB0020002 — VPN connects but no access to internal systems

Priority: P3 | **Category:** VPN | **Keywords:** VPN connected no access, can't reach internal sites, VPN slow, VPN drops, VPN tunnel unstable

Symptoms: VPN client shows "Connected," but internal systems, shared drives, or intranet sites fail to load or time out.

Cause: Usually an unstable tunnel connection (common on public wifi) or a routing issue affecting specific internal systems rather than the VPN session itself.

Resolution:

Confirm the VPN client shows "Connected" status, not "Connecting" or "Reconnecting."

Try accessing a different internal system to establish whether the issue is specific to one application or affects everything.

Disconnect and reconnect the VPN session — intermittent tunnel drops are common on unstable public wifi.

If using public wifi, some networks block or throttle the VPN protocol; try a mobile hotspot as a test.

Escalation trigger: Access fails consistently across multiple internal systems while VPN shows connected status — this suggests a server-side routing issue outside the user's control.

Related Articles: KB0020001 (VPN won't connect), KB0070001 (Network drive not accessible)

Category 3: Software Access Requests

KB0030001 — Request access to a standard business application

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Software Access | **Keywords:** need access, software access request, can't open application, permission denied, access request, software catalogue

Symptoms: User cannot open or is not licensed for an application they need for their role.

Cause: Standard business applications require an explicit license/access grant even when installed — this is licensing control, not a fault, and self-service provisioning exists for the majority of standard tools.

Resolution:

Go to the MyTech portal → Software Catalogue.

Search for the application by name.

Submit the request — standard applications are typically auto-approved and provisioned within 1 hour.

Restart your device after provisioning to ensure the new install/license is picked up correctly.

Escalation trigger: The application isn't listed in the Software Catalogue, or it requires named manager approval outside the standard auto-approval flow.

Related Articles: KB0030002 (Access Denied error)

KB0030002 — "Access Denied" error opening a shared application

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Software Access | **Keywords:** access denied, permission error, can't open file, unauthorized, application error

Symptoms: User previously had access to an application or shared resource and now receives an "Access Denied" or "Unauthorized" error.

Cause: Most commonly caused by a recent application update or reinstall resetting local permission caches, rather than an actual removal of access rights.

Resolution:

Confirm you're logged in with your standard L&G account, not a personal or guest profile.

Check whether the application was recently reinstalled or updated — permissions occasionally reset after updates.

Try accessing from a different L&G device if available, to isolate whether the issue is device-specific or account-specific.

Escalation trigger: Access was previously working and stopped with no known change on the user's end — this may indicate a backend permissions change requiring investigation.

Related Articles: KB0030001 (Software access request)

Category 4: Email / Outlook Issues

KB0040001 — Outlook not syncing / stuck sending

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Email | **Keywords:** outlook not syncing, email stuck, email not sending, outlook frozen, outbox stuck

Symptoms: Emails remain in the Outbox without sending, or new mail stops arriving despite an active connection.

Cause: Usually a sync interruption or, less commonly, a mailbox approaching its storage limit, which causes Outlook to silently fail to send without a clear error message.

Resolution:

Check your internet connection is stable.

In Outlook, go to Send/Receive → Update Folder to force a manual sync.
If emails are stuck in the Outbox, restart Outlook fully (not just minimised).
Check your mailbox isn't near its storage limit — Outlook will silently fail to send if the mailbox is full.

Escalation trigger: Restart doesn't resolve it and mailbox storage is confirmed not to be the cause.

Related Articles: KB0040002 (Not receiving expected emails)

KB0040002 — Not receiving expected emails

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Email | **Keywords:** not receiving emails, missing emails, email not arriving, email lost

Symptoms: User reports a specific expected email, or emails generally, are not arriving in their inbox.

Cause: The majority of "missing email" reports are resolved by checking Junk/Clutter, or are caused by an inbox rule the user set up previously and forgot about, silently redirecting mail.

Resolution:

Check your Junk/Clutter folder first — this resolves the majority of reports.
Confirm with the sender they used your correct, current email address.
Check any active inbox rules (File → Manage Rules) that might be redirecting mail without your knowledge.

Escalation trigger: Email genuinely isn't arriving anywhere, isn't a rule or junk issue, and the sender confirms correct address — may indicate a mail flow/routing problem.

Related Articles: KB0040001 (Outlook not syncing)

Category 5: Printer / Hardware Issues

KB0050001 — Can't print / printer shows offline

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Hardware | **Keywords:** printer offline, can't print, printer not responding, print job stuck, printer error

Symptoms: Printer shows as "offline" in the device's printer list, or print jobs sit in the queue without completing.

Cause: Most commonly a stale network connection between the device and printer, or a stuck job blocking the queue — rarely an actual printer hardware fault.

Resolution:

Confirm the printer is powered on and shows a ready status on its own display panel.
On your device, remove and re-add the printer (Settings → Printers & Scanners).
Clear any stuck jobs from the print queue before resubmitting.

Try printing a test page directly from the printer's own menu to isolate whether it's a network issue or a device issue.

Escalation trigger: Printer is powered on and network-connected but still won't accept jobs from any device — indicates a genuine printer or network fault.

Related Articles: none

KB0050002 — Laptop won't turn on / won't charge

Priority: P3 | **Category:** Hardware | **Keywords:** laptop won't turn on, won't charge, battery dead, no power, laptop dead

Symptoms: Device does not power on, or shows no charging indicator when plugged in.

Cause: Frequently a faulty cable or loose connection rather than a battery or motherboard fault — worth ruling out before assuming hardware failure.

Resolution:

Try a different power outlet and, if possible, a different charging cable, to rule out a faulty cable. Hold the power button for 15 seconds to force a full shutdown, then attempt to power on again. Check the charging cable is fully seated at both ends.

Escalation trigger: Device still won't power on or charge after cable/outlet checks — requires physical hardware inspection.

Related Articles: none

Category 6: MFA / Authentication Problems

KB0060001 — Not receiving MFA push notification / code

Priority: P3 | **Category:** MFA | **Keywords:** MFA not working, no push notification, authenticator app not working, can't get code, MFA timeout

Symptoms: User does not receive the expected push notification or one-time code during login.

Cause: Almost always a connectivity or device time-sync issue on the phone itself, rather than a fault with the MFA service.

Resolution:

Confirm your phone has an active internet or mobile data connection — push notifications require connectivity. Open the Authenticator app directly and manually refresh rather than waiting for the push. Check the app isn't awaiting an update in your phone's app store, which can sometimes block notifications.

Confirm system time on your phone is set to automatic — manually incorrect time is a common cause of code mismatches.

Escalation trigger: MFA still fails after connectivity and time-sync checks — requires manual identity verification, not further self-service.

Related Articles: KB0060002 (Lost/replaced phone)

KB0060002 — Lost or replaced phone, can't complete MFA

Priority: P3 | **Category:** MFA | **Keywords:** new phone MFA, lost phone, MFA device changed, re-register MFA, phone upgrade

Symptoms: User has a new or replacement phone and can no longer complete MFA using their previously registered device.

Cause: Expected behaviour — MFA is deliberately tied to a specific registered device as a security control, not a fault.

Resolution: This cannot be resolved via self-service, for security reasons. Re-registering MFA on a new device requires identity verification by the service desk to prevent account takeover.

Escalation trigger: Always — this category is never self-service resolvable, and should route straight to incident creation with no deflection attempt.

Related Articles: KB0060001 (MFA not receiving code)

Category 7: Network Drive / Shared Folder Access

KB0070001 — Can't access shared/network drive

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Network Storage | **Keywords:** network drive not accessible, shared drive missing, can't find drive, mapped drive gone, drive not showing

Symptoms: Mapped network drive doesn't appear in File Explorer, or shows as disconnected/red X.

Cause: Most commonly a lost VPN session when working remotely, or a mapping that failed to reconnect after the device woke from sleep.

Resolution:

Confirm you're connected to VPN if working remotely — network drives require an active VPN session off-site.

Try accessing the drive via its full network path rather than the mapped letter (e.g. `\\server\sharename`). Restart your device — drive mappings occasionally fail to reconnect after sleep/hibernation.

Escalation trigger: Path is correct, VPN is connected, and the drive still won't load — may indicate a permissions or server-side issue.

Related Articles: KB0020002 (VPN connects but no access), KB0070002 (Shared folder permissions)

KB0070002 — "You don't have permission" on a shared folder you previously accessed

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Network Storage | **Keywords:** shared folder permission denied, folder access removed, network folder error

Symptoms: A shared folder the user previously had access to now shows a permissions error, despite the drive itself being reachable.

Cause: Usually a group membership change (e.g. team restructure, role change) that removed the underlying permission grant, rather than a fault.

Resolution:

Confirm the drive itself is reachable and other folders on the same drive open normally, to isolate the issue to this specific folder.

Check with a colleague who has recently accessed the same folder whether they can still get in — helps confirm whether it's account-specific or affects the whole team.

Note any recent role or team changes that might explain a legitimate permission change.

Escalation trigger: Always for this scenario — folder-level permission grants can't be self-service restored and require the resource owner or service desk to re-grant access.

Related Articles: KB0070001 (Network drive not accessible)

Category 8: Teams Audio / Video Issues

KB0080001 — No audio or camera not working in Teams call

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Teams | **Keywords:** teams no audio, camera not working, can't hear, microphone not working, teams call issues, no sound

Symptoms: Other participants can't hear the user, or the user's camera doesn't appear in a Teams call.

Cause: Most commonly the wrong device selected in Teams settings, or another application already holding the microphone/camera lock.

Resolution:

Check the correct microphone/speaker/camera is selected in Teams (Settings → Devices), not a disconnected external device.

Confirm no other application (e.g. another call app) is already using the camera or microphone.

Leave and rejoin the call — this resolves the majority of one-off device connection glitches.

Restart Teams fully if the issue persists across multiple calls.

Escalation trigger: Devices test fine in other applications but Teams still can't access them after a restart.

Related Articles: KB0080002 (Poor call quality)

KB0080002 — Teams call quality poor, freezing, or lagging

Priority: P4 | **Category:** Teams | **Keywords:** teams freezing, teams lagging, poor call quality, teams call dropping, choppy audio

Symptoms: Audio cutting out, video freezing, or repeated "reconnecting" messages during a Teams call.

Cause: Almost always network bandwidth related — either local wifi congestion or, for remote workers, VPN routing overhead affecting real-time media quality.

Resolution:

Switch off video if only audio is essential — video consumes significantly more bandwidth and is the first thing to degrade on a weak connection.

If working remotely and the call doesn't require internal-only access, temporarily disconnect VPN, as VPN routing adds latency to real-time media.

Move closer to the wifi router or switch to a wired connection if available.

Escalation trigger: Poor quality persists consistently across multiple networks and devices for the same user, ruling out local network causes.

Related Articles: KB0080001 (No audio or camera)

Total: 16 articles across 8 categories (2 per category).